To Strategy & Analytics team **From** Freya Lindqvist, Head of Growth **Re** Germany market entry

Germany market entry — we need a price, a launch channel, and a timeline

LUMEN launched in Copenhagen in 2022: a low-sugar, sparkling functional drink built on natural caffeine from green tea and a light adaptogen blend. We've spent four years earning our place on shelves and screens in the Netherlands, Denmark and Sweden. Germany is next — Europe's largest market for functional beverages, and the one every investor asks us about first.

€9.1bn	~7%	~35%	4
German functional-beverage market, 2026	Category CAGR through 2033	Germany's share of European category value	Established competitors already on German shelves

WHY NOW

NL/DK/SE now generate roughly €1.2M in trailing-twelve-month revenue (€1.6M over the 78 weeks in Exhibit 6) and the brand has real repeat-purchase loyalty in Copenhagen and Amsterdam. Investors keep asking about Germany specifically — it's the obvious next market, not an opportunistic one.

COMPETITOR LANDSCAPE, AT A GLANCE

BRAND	POSITIONING	PRICE BAND
PulsUp	Mass market	€1.0–1.3
Mate Libre	Heritage, loyal niche	€1.4–1.8
VoltFit	Premium performance	€2.1–2.7
Root & Rise	Boutique adaptogenic	€2.5–3.1

MESSAGE — Slack #leadership-sync Today, 08:41

Quick context before you dig in, because you'll hit this tension in the data whether or not I flag it now. Jonas (CMO) wants us to launch positioned next to VoltFit and Root & Rise: clean-label story, premium shelf price, brand-building spend. Elena (CFO) is watching runway and wants a price and channel mix that pays back its marketing spend fast, not eighteen months from now. I don't think we can fully give both of them what they're asking for at the same time — and I'd rather you tell me where the real trade-off is than hand me a number that quietly picks a side.

What I need: a recommendation on **price**, **positioning** and **which channel(s) to launch in first** for Germany, backed by something I can actually poke at — not another slide deck. Use whatever you need from the data room. Some of it comes from our home markets, not Germany itself, because we obviously don't have German sales yet — that's not a gap, that's the job.

— Freya

THE DECISION

At what price, through which channel(s), and roughly when should LUMEN launch in Germany — and what are we deliberately choosing not to optimise for by picking it?

Exhibits

Twelve files, in `data/`. Full detail and column-by-column notes are in `README_data.md` — this page is a map, not a substitute for opening the files.

EXHIBIT	FILE	CONTENTS
1	market_context.csv	DE market size by sub-category & by region/city, 2022–27
2	competitor_prices_by_channel.csv	4 competitors × channel × pack format pricing
3	competitor_price_history.csv	12 months of competitor price & promo activity
4	customer_survey.csv	~420 German respondents: segment, spend, channel, awareness, intent
5	customer_quotes.csv	Qualitative verbatims by segment
6	historical_sales_weekly.csv	78 weeks of actual sales, NL/DK/SE only
7	marketing_funnel_monthly.csv	18 months, reach → engagement → conversion → CAC → LTV, by channel
8	cost_breakdown.csv	Per-unit cost structure & current blended gross margin
9	channel_economics.csv	What LUMEN nets per unit after retailer/distributor/payment cuts, by channel
10	price_sensitivity_survey.csv	~300 respondents, 4 Van Westendorp price thresholds each
11	price_test_results.csv	3 candidate prices × channel: acceptance & contribution margin
12	seasonality_and_weather.csv	Monthly demand seasonality index & avg. German temperature

€44
Blended CAC across all marketing channels (Exhibit 7)

30%
Current blended gross margin, home markets (Exhibit 8)

3:1
Target LTV:CAC ratio the plan assumes (Exhibit 7)

3
Candidate launch prices to evaluate (Exhibit 11)

PRICE	EST. ACCEPTANCE	CONTRIBUTION / UNIT	RANGE ACROSS CHANNELS (EXHIBIT 11)
€1.79	61.7%	€0.40–€0.81	Best acceptance, thinnest margin
€2.19	51.7%	€0.63–€1.16	Balanced acceptance/margin trade-off
€2.59	26.7%	€0.86–€1.54	Best margin, acceptance nearly halves

WORTH KNOWING GOING IN

The three candidate prices (€1.79 / €2.19 / €2.59) are reported **per channel, not blended** — the channel mix for Germany is one of the calls we're asking you to make, so we didn't pre-bake it into "the answer." Some data is imperfect on purpose; treat it the way you would a real export, not a textbook table.

OPTIONAL, NOT REQUIRED

If your team wants to push further: nothing stops you pulling in a live public data source (e.g. current German weather) and correlating it with Exhibit 12. A genuinely harder stretch: reconcile Exhibit 5's qualitative quotes against Exhibit 4's quantitative survey where they seem to disagree.

STUCK? TOOL IDEAS TO START FROM

A menu, not a checklist — pick one, combine a few, or use these to trigger a better idea of your own.

Pricing simulator
Price → volume & margin trade-off

Positioning map
LUMEN vs. competitors, price × perception

Marketing ROI simulator
Budget by channel → CAC, payback, LTV

City launch prioritiser
Which German region to enter first

Risk / scenario simulator
Range of outcomes, not one number

Decision cockpit
Combine several of these into one view

Qual/quant reconciler
Where the quotes and the survey disagree

Launch-timing indicator
Seasonality + competitor activity → when

Recommendation memo generator
Turns your inputs into a one-page write-up